

Try these...

Shaping sounds

Your baby's speech is moving along rapidly: she may be pointing and trying to name objects, so give her a chance to shape a sound or babble before you name the object for her.

Little helper

Give your baby a simple request, for example, "Please give me the cup." Point at what you want, nod encouragement, and she'll want to help by passing it to you.

Have a chat

She may love to babble, which has the rhythm and tone of a real conversation. Listen to her attentively when she's trying out sounds such as "ka" for "cup."

Sit face to face, make eye contact, watch her lips so you can practice with her, and use the same rhythm as you repeat her words back to her. Enjoy this time "chatting" together—the process of gaining speech is one of incredible speed and complexity, so revel in how far she's come.

ka